Insofar as the Research and Analysis Wing's (R&AW's) involvement in Op-2 was concerned, things started changing towards the end of 1980 when a new division headed by Deputy Director B. Raman was created, to 'collect intelligence about the activities of the Sikh extremist elements abroad and their links with the ISI' [3] of Pakistan. In early 1981, director (R&AW), in short director (R), N.F. Suntook asked me to send proposals to the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) for the positioning of seven new R&AW stations in some Indian missions located in west Europe and North America.

Sometime in the middle of 1981, I was asked by Suntook to brief the R&AW officers, of and above the rank of deputy director posted at headquarters, on the concept of Khalistan and the type of information they should be looking for. On his appointment as senior advisor in August 1981, R.N. Kao also started using the R&AW's resources to further the cause of certain aspects of Op-2. It was in that context that I was asked by the director (R) to visit Canada and the US thrice between December 1981 and September 1983.

Sometime in February-March 1990, B. Raman prepared the R&AW's white paper on 'Khalistan and Sikh Extremism'. With the approval of Secretary (R) A.K. Verma, Raman decided to present it to a select group of senior R&AW officers and some invitees from sister organizations dealing with security-related matters, which included the Intelligence Bureau. The invitees also included some Delhi police officers who were on duty during the November 1984 pogrom. Air Commodore Jasjit Singh (Retd), director of the Institute of Defence Studies and Analysis (IDSA) and a Sikh, was invited to chair the meeting at the R&AW's plush auditorium.

Raman approached the lectern and started addressing the audience with the 'white paper' in his hand. He said the Sikhs had never forgotten the prestige and eminence of the Sikh empire (1709–1848) established by Maharaja Ranjit Singh and wanted to recreate that era in one form or the other. He also gave some details of the activities of Jagjit Singh Chauhan and Sikh extremist organizations. He linked their activities to the lingering desire on the part of the Sikhs to secure an independent Sikh state called